

DRAMA

OVERVIEW

At the Grade 11 and 12 level, drama students extend their understanding and interpretation of dramatic texts, forms, characters, and theatrical productions. They incorporate a variety of dramatic elements and conventions in their performances and productions. Students engage in increasingly effective social interactions and collaboration as they create, perform, and analyse drama. In these courses, students will experience being performer, audience, playwright, technician, designer, and critic.

Students use the elements of drama (role/character, relationship, time and place, focus and emphasis, and tension) to create works that are related to their personal interest and experience. In doing so, they integrate technology to enhance the impact of drama works and to help convey mood, create tension, and communicate a message.

Students examine how different styles and traditions of drama can affect social and cultural conditions in a variety of Canadian and global contexts. Students explore various opportunities for careers in drama and other arts while developing skills that can be linked to a range of careers. They enhance their ability to analyse and interpret a range of drama work, and reflect on and evaluate their own and others' creative work.

The expectations for drama courses are organized in three distinct but related strands:

1. ***Creating and Presenting:*** Students use the creative process (see pages 15–17) to develop, produce, and perform drama. Students interpret dramatic texts and use appropriate dramatic forms, elements, techniques, and technologies to present their ideas and achieve specific purposes. In all creative projects, students will develop and present their work both individually and in ensemble.
2. ***Reflecting, Responding, and Analysing:*** In this strand, students use the critical analysis process (see pages 17–22) to identify and reflect on their response to dramatic works and develop their understanding of how dramatic purpose is achieved. Students explore how societies present and past use or have used drama, and they reflect on ways in which drama can lead to a deeper understanding of themselves and the communities in which they live. Students are challenged to examine their artistic choices and processes and to determine what they have learned from them.
3. ***Foundations:*** This strand addresses dramatic forms, conventions, practices, and skills. Students refine their knowledge of theoretical concepts through active engagement in drama. They deepen their understanding of the origins and development of drama and theatre arts and their influence on past and present societies. They communicate by using terminology specific to creating, presenting, and analysing drama. Students continue to study the significance of health and safety issues as well as a variety of protocols related to ethics and etiquette in drama activities.

For policy guidelines pertaining to focus courses, see pages 12–13 of this document.
The list of approved focus courses for Drama can be found at:
www.edu.gov.on.ca/eng/curriculum/secondary/arts.html.

Drama, Grade 11

Open

ADA30

This course requires students to engage in dramatic processes and the presentation of dramatic works, and emphasizes the application of drama skills in other contexts and opportunities. Students will interpret and present works in a variety of dramatic forms, create and script original works, and critically analyse the processes involved in producing drama works. Students will develop a variety of skills related to collaboration and the presentation of drama works.

Prerequisite: None

A. CREATING AND PRESENTING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1. The Creative Process:** use the creative process and a variety of sources and forms, both individually and collaboratively, to design and develop drama works;
- A2. Elements and Conventions:** use the elements and conventions of drama effectively in creating individual and ensemble drama works, including works based on a variety of sources;
- A3. Presentation Techniques and Technologies:** use a variety of presentation techniques and technological tools to enhance the impact of drama works and communicate for specific audiences and purposes.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. The Creative Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1.1** develop interpretations of contemporary and historical sources from diverse cultures to use as the basis for drama (*e.g., use narratives, poetry, paintings, photographs, or Internet postings as the basis for a dramatic monologue or dialogue; use interviews with guest artists or stage performers as the basis for a scene about "A day in the life of an actor"; try out different scenarios for dramatizing an event from the past*)

Teacher prompt: "Could a situation like the one these historical characters are facing happen today? What would it be like? How could you dramatize your source in a modern setting?"

- A1.2** select and use appropriate dramatic forms to present themes or ideas about diverse cultures, contexts, and perspectives (*e.g., use choral speaking, spoken word, and/or mime to dramatize an Aboriginal or Caribbean folk tale; use tableaux with transitions to dramatize a traditional saying or proverb*)

Teacher prompt: "How could a chorus support a drama that uses mime?"

- A1.3** use role play to explore the possibilities of different scenarios, situations, and characters (*e.g., use forum theatre to develop scenes for an original presentation; use improvisation to create two different endings for a specific scene*)

Teacher prompt: "What insights or actions from your improvised scene could you include in the final presentation?"

A2. Elements and Conventions

By the end of this course, students will:

- A2.1** identify distinctive uses of the elements of drama in texts and sources from a range of cultures and incorporate them in their own drama works (*e.g., use trickster characters such as Nanabush, coyote, and Anansi from Aboriginal and Caribbean folk tales; observe unity of time and place, as in the drama of ancient Greece*)

Teacher prompt: "How can you present this story so that all the action happens within one day?"

- A2.2** use a variety of drama conventions to clarify roles, relationships, and themes in individual and ensemble drama works (*e.g., use inner and outer circle, overheard conversations, and forum theatre to highlight different characters' views; use caption making or collective drawing to clarify focus*)

Teacher prompts: "As you role play and write in role, pay attention to any insights you are gaining. Express your new ideas to the group and then work from those ideas to deepen the drama." "What images or slogans can you think of to express the central idea of your scene? How could you incorporate that idea into the action?"

A3. Presentation Techniques and Technologies

By the end of this course, students will:

A3.1 use a variety of techniques and technologies to communicate ideas to different audiences and for different purposes (*e.g., use available sound and light technologies to adapt scenes to appeal to different audiences – young people, seniors, special interest groups; use an opening sound cue to establish the mood and engage the audience in a children's theatre production*)

Teacher prompts: “How will you use music and lighting to engage your audience? How could you use sound and lighting to create a particular mood?” “What kind of audience should hear the important messages that you want to communicate? What strategies can you use to entice the audience into hearing/seeing/experiencing your work so that they are moved and transformed by the experience?”

A3.2 select and use appropriate role development techniques during rehearsal and performance (*e.g., techniques such as warm-ups, voice and movement exercises, concentration exercises, improvisation, guided tour*)

Teacher prompt: “How does improvising outside your given scene assist you in developing your character? What did you discover about this character that you didn’t know before?”

A3.3 select and use a variety of technological tools to enhance the expressiveness and impact of drama works (*e.g., dim the lighting to signal the approach of danger; use sound effects to suggest a particular type of action or mood*)

Teacher prompts: “What technological means could you use to communicate the atmosphere of your scene?” “How could you use light and sound effects to help communicate the underlying theme of your work?”

B. REFLECTING, RESPONDING, AND ANALYSING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. The Critical Analysis Process:** use the critical analysis process to reflect on and evaluate their own and others' drama works and activities;
- B2. Drama and Society:** demonstrate an understanding of how societies present and past use or have used drama, and of how creating and viewing drama can benefit individuals, groups, and communities;
- B3. Connections Beyond the Classroom:** identify knowledge and skills they have acquired through drama activities, and demonstrate an understanding of ways in which they can apply this learning in personal, social, and career contexts.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. The Critical Analysis Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** use the critical analysis process before and during drama projects to assign roles appropriately within the group and to monitor the group process (e.g., use journal writing, large-group discussions, one-to-one feedback, think-pair-share, and student-developed criteria to record activities and provide feedback to all group members)

Teacher prompts: "Why is it useful to maintain a rehearsal log, planning journal, or production schedule when working on a project?" "What is the value of monitoring attendance, promptness, focus, and preparation in the rehearsal process?"

- B1.2** analyse drama works to determine how well they achieve their intended purpose (e.g., express opinions in follow-up discussions about the communicative effectiveness of their own and others' drama works and performances)

Teacher prompts: "In your opinion, what is the essential conflict between these characters? Do you think the author intended us to see it that way? What evidence can you find for your interpretation?" "In what way did the staging support or enhance the play's message?"

- B1.3** identify aesthetic and technical aspects of a variety of drama works, either completed or in progress, suggest reasons for their use, and

assess their effectiveness (e.g., in a large-group discussion, debate different options for lighting; write a review of a performance that includes an evaluation of the positioning and movement of the actors)

Teacher prompts: "Did the lighting enhance the impact of the scene?" "How could the blocking be changed to focus more attention on the eavesdropper's reactions?"

B2. Drama and Society

By the end of this course, students will:

- B2.1** identify different purposes for drama and the forms used to achieve these purposes in diverse communities and cultures from the past and present (e.g., to provide entertainment and escape – musical comedy; to comment on social absurdity or hypocrisy – comedy of manners; to draw attention to problems or promote attitudinal change – issue-based drama; to explore aspects of social status or class – commedia dell'arte)

Teacher prompts: "What are some examples of contemporary issue-based drama (e.g., The Laramie Project; productions of Dreamrider Theatre or Ubom! Eastern Cape Drama Company)?" "What social purpose does issue-based theatre serve?" "How does studying the time period of a drama work help you understand its purpose?" "How does commedia dell'arte reflect its time period?"

B2.2 identify ways in which drama can promote self- and social awareness (e.g., *creating and performing can promote self-awareness, self-confidence, and personal growth; role playing can promote social understanding and increase one's capacity for empathy*)

Teacher prompts: "What have you learned about your attitudes and abilities through participating in drama?" "Has taking on the role of another character changed your perception of particular people or groups in our society? Why or why not?"

B2.3 identify ways in which drama works can promote social improvement and good citizenship (e.g., *by exploring issues and raising questions about the way things are; by modelling positive solutions to problems*)

Teacher prompts: "Did creating an anti-bullying presentation for an elementary school give you a better understanding of how to prevent or combat bullying in your own life?" "Why might students find a drama about bullying more helpful than a simple classroom discussion?"

B2.4 identify and interpret types of drama and specific drama works that portray distinct cultures and traditions (e.g., *develop a hypothesis about the reasons for the ritual and symbolism of political or religious ceremonies or the use of masked actors in theatre traditions in different cultures*)

Teacher prompt: "What are some of the characteristics of this drama work? What does it communicate about the beliefs, values, or traditions of its culture of origin?"

B3. Connections Beyond the Classroom

By the end of this course, students will:

B3.1 describe and assess the role of collaboration in their creative process (e.g., *identify aspects of their group creative process that required collaborative as well as individual effort and suggest*

possible improvements; outline the steps they used to define and allocate roles, establish timelines, and monitor how individuals carried out their responsibilities)

Teacher prompt: "How were responsibilities allocated to team members during the rehearsal process? Did the process work well? What could you do to improve the process next time?"

B3.2 identify problem-solving techniques they have learned through drama activities, and explain how they can be applied in work and other social contexts (e.g., *as a group, create a presentation to model for other students how they used respectful discussion and debate to identify and analyse problems, brainstorm possible solutions, choose an acceptable option, monitor progress, and modify plans if necessary*)

Teacher prompt: "What are some problems you encountered when working in your drama group? How did you go about solving these problems? Would these techniques work in other group situations? Why or why not?"

B3.3 relate skills and knowledge they have developed through drama to opportunities for employment in the broader educational and arts sectors (e.g., *create a scrapbook or portfolio that showcases their set design work; identify cooperative education placements that reflect their particular theatre interests; write a résumé to support an application for an audition; write a review of a community theatre production and post it on the Internet or submit it for publication to a community newspaper*)

Teacher prompt: "What have you learned from your drama studies that you can apply to your part-time job, postsecondary study, or potential employment opportunities?"

C. FOUNDATIONS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Concepts and Terminology:** demonstrate an understanding of the nature and functions of drama forms, elements, conventions, and techniques, including the correct terminology for the various components;
- C2. Contexts and Influences:** demonstrate an understanding of the origins and development of drama and theatre arts and their influence on past and present societies;
- C3. Responsible Practices:** demonstrate an understanding of safe, ethical, and responsible personal and interpersonal practices in drama activities.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Concepts and Terminology

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** identify and describe the forms, elements, conventions, and techniques used in a variety of drama styles, and explain their function in their own and others' drama works (*e.g., explain the use of non-realistic, stylized movements in commedia dell'arte, exaggerated movements in melodrama, neutral and/or character masks in mime*)

Teacher prompt: "How would you describe this style of movement? What type of message does it convey?"

- C1.2** use correct terminology for the forms, elements, conventions, and techniques they learn about through viewing and creating drama works (*e.g., improvisational scene work, gesture, voice, in role, motivation, mime, simulation*)

Teacher prompt: "What terms do we use to describe the structure of the action in comedy? In tragedy? How could this information help you in structuring your own scenes?"

- C1.3** demonstrate an understanding of production and promotion roles, practices, and terminology in producing and presenting drama works (*e.g., production roles: stage manager, make-up designer, wardrobe manager; promotion and*

marketing tools and procedures: poster, program, brochure, direct-mail campaign, advertising campaign, press relations strategy)

Teacher prompts: "What are some specific responsibilities of a stage manager?" "What is the role of the artistic director of the Stratford Festival?"

C2. Contexts and Influences

By the end of this course, students will:

- C2.1** identify and describe theatre traditions from various cultures and historical periods (*e.g., summarize the key characteristics and/or conventions of Thai shadow puppetry, Renaissance drama, commedia dell'arte*)

Teacher prompt: "What groups in society are depicted in these dramas? What are the most common themes?"

- C2.2** describe ways in which contemporary dramas show the influence of current media (*e.g., media settings or personalities provide content and themes for drama; emerging media such as blogs or videos provide new vehicles for drama; media products such as reality television suggest new forms for drama*)

Teacher prompt: "What are some similarities between reality television shows and improvised scene work?"

C3. Responsible Practices

By the end of this course, students will:

C3.1 identify and follow safe and ethical practices in all drama activities (*e.g., follow safety rules and procedures when performing backstage tasks and operating technical equipment; follow procedures for the environmentally responsible use of materials and energy; make character, scene, and script choices that reflect community standards; acknowledge source material when producing and/or presenting a partial or complete drama work*)

Teacher prompts: “What safety issues must we consider when using lighting equipment in a production?” “What safety precautions do theatre technicians take when producing a show?” “How can we ensure that the materials used in our sets are available for re-use in future productions?” “Why is it important to avoid offensive language in a production for a young audience?”

C3.2 demonstrate an understanding of the tasks and responsibilities involved in producing drama works (*e.g., show up on time; clarify responsibilities; cooperate to build trust; carry out duties consistently and fully*)

Teacher prompts: “Why is producing drama a team effort?” “What role(s) beyond the stage character will you take on when producing your scene? What skills and attitudes do your additional responsibilities require?”

C3.3 observe correct theatre and audience etiquette in classroom drama work and formal performance contexts (*e.g., as an audience member: avoid behaviour that could distract performers or other audience members; as a performer: take direction respectfully, respond appropriately to the director’s notes, cooperate with the stage manager*)

Teacher prompts: “What are the differences between attending a rock concert and a theatre production?” “How can you show appreciation for the actors without disrupting their concentration?”